

Neo-Geo

Short for 'Neo-Geometric Conceptualism', Neo-Geo has also been called Neo-Conceptualism, Neo-Futurism, Neo-Op, Neo-Pop, New Abstraction, Neo-Minimalism, Simulationism and Smart Art.

Developed in the 1980s, it describes the work of a loose group of artists who criticized mechanization and commercialism. Yet paradoxically, its popularity was largely fuelled by aggressive marketing. Artists linked to the movement include Ashley Bickerton (b.1959), Peter Halley (b.1953), Lorenzo Belenguer (b.1965), Jeff Koons (b.1955), Meyer Vaisman (b.1960), David Burdeny (b.1968), Haim Steinbach (b.1944), Peter Schuyff (b.1958) and Marjan Eggermont (b.1966). Styles varied, but all these artists began from similar standpoints and all worked figuratively, drawing on earlier movements including Minimalism, Abstract Expressionism, Pop and Op art. They developed a new form of geometric painting and three-dimensional work, some bright and colourful, some austere, and often featuring items such as microchips and circuit boards. The steel sculptures of Richard Serra (b.1939) have been described as 'austere Neo-Geo'.



Javier Mariscal, *La Gamba*, 1989